

WHO IS JEREMIAH?

*The Weeping Prophet Who Remained Faithful to
God*

*“Before I formed you in the womb,
I knew you... I appointed you as a
prophet to the nations.”*

Jeremiah 1:5



Learning Objectives

What we will understand today

Know who Jeremiah was and why God called him.

Understand the historical crisis of Judah and Babylon.

See why Jeremiah is remembered as the “weeping prophet.”

Connect Jeremiah’s suffering with trauma awareness and emotional healing.

Reflect on faithful obedience, compassion, and hope.

Bible study goal: not just information, but formation — learning to listen to God faithfully in painful seasons.

Group rhythm: Scripture • Context
• Story • Reflection • Prayer

Who Was Jeremiah?

A prophet called during a national crisis



One of the Major Prophets of the Old Testament.

Son of Hilkiah, a priest from Anathoth. Called by God while still young.

Ministered through the final years of Judah before Jerusalem fell.

His message carried both warning and hope.

Read: Jeremiah 1:1–10

Jeremiah's Calling

God knew, set apart, and appointed him

*“Before I formed you in the womb
I knew you, before you were
born, I set you apart.”*

Jeremiah 1:5

Application: God's work in us often begins before we fully understand ourselves.

God's calling was personal: “I knew you.”

God's calling was purposeful: “I set you apart.”

God's calling was missional: “I appointed you.”

God's calling was sustained by His presence.

Jeremiah Felt Inadequate

God's presence answered his fear

Jeremiah said: “I do not know how to speak.”

He also said: “I am too young.”

God replied: “Do not say, I am too young.”

God promised to be with him and rescue him.

God touched his mouth and gave him words.

“Do not be afraid of them, for I am with you and will rescue you.”

Jeremiah 1:8

Teaching point: God does not ignore fear; He meets His servant in fear.

Historical Background

Judah, Babylon, and the coming exile



Map: Judah to Babylon

Jeremiah ministered around 627–586 BC.

Judah was spiritually declining and politically unstable.

Babylon rose as the dominant empire.

Jerusalem was destroyed in 586 BC. The exile became a national wound and theological crisis.

Timeline of Jeremiah's Ministry

From calling to exile



Jeremiah lived through slow decline, repeated warnings, national collapse, and grief after destruction.

Jeremiah's Mission

To uproot and to plant

“See, today I appoint you over nations and kingdoms to uproot and tear down... to build and to plant.”

Jeremiah 1:10

Prophetic ministry is not only prediction; it is God confronting the present and opening a path back to Him.

Warn Judah about sin and idolatry.

Call the people to repentance.
Expose injustice and false security.

Announce coming judgment through Babylon.

Declare God's promise of restoration.

Opposition Jeremiah Faced

Faithfulness did not make life easy

Mocked and rejected by his people.

Accused of weakening the nation.

Beaten and placed in stocks.

Threatened and imprisoned.

Thrown into a muddy cistern.

Often felt alone in his calling.

Read: Jeremiah 20:1–2; 38:6



Why “The Weeping Prophet”?

His tears revealed compassion

*“Oh, that my head were a spring
of water and my eyes a fountain
of tears!”*

Jeremiah 9:1

Biblical grief is not the opposite of faith. It can be a faithful response to pain.

Jeremiah grieved because the people rejected God.

He saw the destruction that was coming.

He carried sorrow for his nation.
His tears were not weakness; they were love.

He shows us that faithful people can also mourn deeply.

The New Covenant

Hope written on the heart

“I will put my law in their minds and write it on their hearts. I will be their God, and they will be my people.”

Jeremiah 31:33

Judgment is not God’s final word; restoration is central to His redemptive heart.

God promised inner transformation, not only outward religion.

God promised restored relationship: “I will be their God.”

God promised forgiveness and mercy.

Christians see this promise fulfilled through Jesus Christ.

The Character of Jeremiah

A life shaped by obedience

Faithful

he kept speaking

Humble

he admitted weakness

Courageous

he obeyed under pressure

Compassionate

he wept for people

Honest

he prayed his pain

Persevering

he endured for years

Reflection: Which character quality do you most need in this season?

Jeremiah and Trauma Awareness

A faithful prophet who experienced deep pain



Jeremiah experienced rejection, betrayal, fear, isolation, public shame, and imprisonment.

The book gives language for grief, lament, anger, confusion, and hope.

Important care principle: trauma is not always caused by personal sin.

Biblical care listens with compassion before giving advice.

Trauma Lens for Bible Study

Seeing pain without losing hope

Developmental / Relational

rejection, loneliness,
betrayal, lack of safety

Threat & Harm

fear, violence,
imprisonment, public
humiliation

Loss & Cultural Trauma

Jerusalem's fall, exile, grief
of a community

A trauma-informed Bible study asks: What happened? What did it cost? Where was God present? What hope does Scripture give?

Emotional Healing in Jeremiah

How God meets wounded hearts

Lament: Jeremiah brings honest pain before God.

Truth: God names sin, injustice, and false security.

Presence: God says, “I am with you.”

Hope: God promises restoration and a new covenant.

Community: healing grows where truth and compassion meet.

“But the Lord is with me like a mighty warrior.”

Jeremiah 20:11

Healing does not erase the story;
God redeems the story.

Discussion Questions

For small group sharing

What part of Jeremiah's calling speaks to you most?

Why do you think people rejected Jeremiah's message?

How does Jeremiah show that grief and faith can exist together?

What is the difference between confronting sin and blaming trauma victims?

Where do you need God's promise, "I am with you," today?

Facilitator tip: Give participants permission to pass. Keep the space safe, confidential, and prayerful.

Suggested timing: 12–18 minutes for group sharing.

Reflection Activity

From lament to hope

Write one honest prayer of lament: “Lord, this hurts because...”

Write one truth from Jeremiah: “Yet You are with me...”

Write one hope-filled response: “Today I will...”
Optional: share with a trusted partner or keep it between you and God.



This activity is not counseling. It is a simple prayer practice of bringing pain honestly before God.

Key Takeaways

What Jeremiah teaches us

God calls ordinary people into costly obedience.

Faithfulness may bring rejection, but God's presence sustains.

Lament is a biblical language for pain.

God confronts sin and also offers restoration.
Trauma-informed care should be truthful, gentle, and hope-filled.

“Call to me and I will answer you and tell you great and unsearchable things you do not know.”

Jeremiah 33:3

Faithfulness, not popularity,
is the measure of obedience.

Closing Prayer

Faithful God, keep us close to You

Heavenly Father, thank You for the life of Jeremiah. Help us to remain faithful when obedience is difficult. Give us courage to speak truth with love, compassion for those who suffer, and hope rooted in Your presence. Heal what is wounded, restore what is broken, and teach us to trust Your covenant love. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Jeremiah 20:11 • Jeremiah 31:33 • Jeremiah 33:3